

ATPL EASA STUDY GUIDE | 010 - AIR LAW

Chapter 17: AIS, AIP & AIRAC System

Syllabus Source: CAE Oxford (pp. 357-374) | Pass Target: >= 90% AviationExam

1. THE INTEGRATED AERONAUTICAL INFORMATION PACKAGE (IAIP)

Under ICAO Annex 15, the purpose of the Aeronautical Information Service (AIS) is to ensure the flow of aeronautical data and information necessary for the safety, regularity, and efficiency of air navigation. The Integrated Aeronautical Information Package (IAIP) consists of:

- AIP (Aeronautical Information Publication): Basic permanent regulatory document for flight operations. Divided into 3 PARTS: GEN (General), ENR (En-Route), and AD (Aerodromes).
- AIP Amendments (AIP AMDT): Permanent changes to the AIP. Regular amendments or AIRAC amendments.
- AIP Supplements (AIP SUP): Temporary changes of long duration (3 MONTHS OR LONGER) or changes with extensive text or graphics. Published on conspicuous YELLOW paper.
- NOTAM (Notice to Airmen): Information of urgent operational significance that cannot be published in the AIP in time. Maximum validity: 3 MONTHS.
- PIB (Pre-flight Information Bulletin): Recapitulation of current NOTAMs and urgent information prepared for flight crews prior to departure.
- AIC (Aeronautical Information Circulars): Notices regarding flight safety, technical, administrative, or legislative matters: White (Administrative), Yellow (Operational / ATC), Pink (Flight Safety awareness), Mauve (Airspace restrictions).

2. THE AIRAC SYSTEM (AVIATIONEXAM CORE)

The Aeronautical Information Regulation and Control (AIRAC) system governs the publication of operationally significant changes on predetermined dates based on a 28-DAY INTERVAL:

- Standard AIRAC Cycle: 28 days. Effective dates are Thursdays at 00:00 UTC.
- Publication Lead Time: Information must be dispatched by AIS at least 42 DAYS prior to the effective date so as to reach recipients at least 28 days before.
- Major Operational Changes: For significant changes (e.g. major airspace restructuring, new ATS routes, new runway), information must be dispatched at least 56 DAYS in advance.

3. NOTAM STRUCTURE & Q-CODE DECODING

NOTAM Item	Operational Meaning & Contents
Q) Line	Contains FIR, 5-letter Q-code (e.g. QFAXX), Traffic (I/V/IV), Purpose (N/B/O/M), Scope (A/E/W), Lower/Upper FL, Coordinates & Radius.
Item A)	ICAO 4-letter location indicator of the aerodrome or FIR (e.g. LEMD, EGLL).
Item B)	Ten-figure date/time group indicating start of validity (YYMMDDHHMM UTC).
Item C)	Ten-figure date/time group indicating end of validity, or 'PERM' for permanent changes, or 'EST' for estimated duration.
Item D)	Daily or periodic schedule of operation (if applicable).
Item E)	Plain-language decoded text of the NOTAM detailing the operational condition.
Items F) & G)	Lower and upper altitude or flight level limits (e.g. GND / FL 120).

4. GLOBAL REPORTING FORMAT (GRF) & SNOWTAM

Condition Code	Runway Contaminant & Depth	Reported Braking Action
RWYCC 6	DRY	Normal braking performance and directional control.
RWYCC 5	FROST, WET (≤ 3 mm water), SLUSH (≤ 3 mm)	Good braking action.
RWYCC 3	COMPACTED SNOW (temp $\leq -15^{\circ}\text{C}$)	Medium braking action.
RWYCC 2	WET COMPACTED SNOW	Medium to poor braking action.
RWYCC 1	ICE	Poor braking action.
RWYCC 0	WET ICE, WATER ON COMPACTED SNOW	LESS THAN POOR / NIL (Operations prohibited).

5. AVIATIONEXAM PRACTICE QUESTIONS (WITH EXPLANATIONS)

Q1: What is the interval between consecutive AIRAC effective dates?

[A] 14 days [B] 28 days [C] 42 days [D] 56 days

[*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. The AIRAC cycle is based on predetermined dates separated by 28 days.

Q2: What is the maximum validity period of a standard NOTAM?

[A] 24 hours [B] 1 month [C] 3 months [D] 6 months

[*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [C]. A NOTAM has a maximum validity period of 3 months.

Q3: What paper color is used to publish AIP Supplements (AIP SUP)?

[A] White [B] Pink [C] Yellow [D] Blue

[*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [C]. AIP Supplements are printed on yellow paper to make them conspicuous.

Q4: How many days in advance must information for major AIRAC changes be dispatched?

[A] 28 days [B] 42 days [C] 56 days [D] 90 days

[*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [C]. Major operational changes require 56 days advance dispatch (standard changes require 42 days).

Q5: Under the Global Reporting Format (GRF), what does a Runway Condition Code (RWYCC) of 6 represent?

[A] Poor braking action on wet ice [B] Dry runway with normal braking [C] Standing water / aquaplaning risk [D] Compacted snow

[*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. RWYCC 6 indicates a dry runway with normal braking performance.